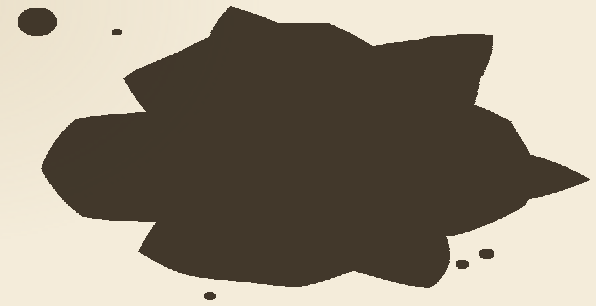




INTERVAL

A H A N D B O O K

world 2e6abe4c99fb

One interval a second since the founding

THIS COPY BELONGS TO

CITIZEN

PRINTED AT INTERVAL

SWORN TO

This book describes world **2e6abe4c99fb**. That is not a version number: it is a checksum of the rules. Change one character of them and you get a different world with a different name. Nothing in this book can go out of date, because nothing in the rules can change.

ABOUT INTERVAL

Interval is an online world run by the computers of the people playing it. There is no company behind it and no server that owns it. There is no account either. You have a key, and the key is your citizen.

The rules were set when the world was founded and cannot be changed by anyone, including the people who wrote them. That is why nobody can ban you, patch you or shut it down, and why this book can be printed at all.

This book lists the rules: the crafts, the items, the recipes, the spells and the levels. It does not tell you what to do, where anything is, or how to make money. Those are not rules, and you work them out by playing.

How the world is drawn is not part of the rules. The window you are using is one way of showing it and there is no official one. You can write your own and it counts the same.

THE INTERVAL

The world advances one interval every second, whether or not anyone is playing. Everything happens on an interval: a step, an attack, a log cut, a line of chat.

Nothing speeds this up. There is nothing to buy, and the world does not pause when you log off.

NINETY MINUTES

You can play one citizen for ninety minutes a day. This is in the rules, so every window enforces it.

When the ninety minutes are used up, you are done for the day.

THE FOUNDING

This book describes the world with the following id, and no other.

2e6abe4c99fb28c24d2a6015918a6b1f
eff216fe9a790f50f4f61038b70e8cc6

Take a SHA-256 checksum of the rules yourself and you should get this. If you get something else, you are playing a different world.



THE ONES WITH A RULE OF THEIR OWN

Most things answer to a good weapon and enough patience. These answer to something else, and the world will not tell you what: it simply refuses, with nothing on screen to say why.

	health	blow	
 quencher	undefined	7	Takes nothing at all from a weapon that does not burn. Not reduced: nothing. Bring fire or do not go.
 barrow wight	undefined	9	Every blow lands for one unless you are carrying holy water. The flask is spent when the wight falls.
 great spider	undefined	18	Its web mends it faster than one person can cut.
 dragon	undefined	28	Struck only from right beside it, so a bow or a spear does nothing, and it breathes.
 gibbet dead	undefined	11	Cannot move and cannot be reached. It throws what comes to hand, and is fought at four tiles or not at all.
 gibbet king	undefined	22	Raises the dead while you fight it, and is struck only from beside it.
 siren	undefined	6	Answers only whoever started with her. Nobody can help you and you cannot help anybody.

There are also 2 practice targets in town. They never fight back and never die.

THE NINE CRAFTS

Every citizen has the same nine and can train all of them. The right column lists the trades you can swear to in that craft.

 Woodcraft	forester, firekeeper, fletcher
 Earthcraft	miner, smith
 Shorecraft	fisher, cook
 Mourning	mourner
 Marksmanship	archer
 Sorcery	alchemist
 Hearthcraft	farmer, brewer
 Prowess	berserker, warden, fighter
 Wayfaring	cartographer, runner

SWEARING TO A TRADE

You can swear to one trade once you reach **50** in its craft. It is the only craft you can master.

Unsworn nothing passes 50

Outside your trade nothing passes 70

Your own craft mastery at 100

Nothing stacks up across crafts. Each citizen masters one craft and stays middling at the other eight, so most of what you need you will get from other players.

CREATURES (CONTINUED)

		health	hardest blow	comes for you
	bear	undefined	2	yes
	shore crab	undefined	2	no
	carrion crow	undefined	2	yes
	goblin	undefined	1	yes
	scree imp	undefined	1	no
	mountain goat	undefined	1	no
	sheep	undefined	1	no

This book does not say where they live.

CREATURES

How much health it has, the hardest it can hit you, and whether it will come for you unprovoked.

		health	hardest blow	comes for you
	mere lamprey	undefined	8	yes
	fen adder	undefined	6	yes
	boar	undefined	5	yes
	risen	undefined	5	yes
	skeleton knight	undefined	4	yes
	incursion	undefined	4	yes
	troll	undefined	3	yes
	wolf	undefined	2	yes

THE TITLES

What a master of each craft is called.

Woodcraft	woodwright
Earthcraft	smith
Shorecraft	shorekeeper
Mourning	mourner
Marksmanship	archer
Sorcery	alchemist
Wayfaring	wayfarer
Hearthcraft	hearthkeeper
Prowess	fighter

PAST MASTERY

Mastery is a power cap, not a level cap. Everything in the world uses your level or 100, whichever is lower, so nothing you do gets stronger past it. Levels carry on to **210** and count for nothing but showing how long you have played.

They do give you apprentice slots, one at each of 100, 105, 110, so a high-level master can teach more people.

TEACHING

Reaching 100 in your own craft does not make you a master. It makes you eligible. You become a master by raising somebody else to their own swearing, and until you have, you are not one.

It cannot be done alone and it cannot be ground out: it needs another citizen to reach 50 and swear, and they have to agree to be taken on in the first place.

newcomer	Unsworn, and nobody has taken them on.
apprentice	Unsworn, but a master has taken them on.
journeyman	Sworn to a trade.
master	At 100, and has raised somebody.

A master holds 3 places at most, and an apprentice who swears frees their own place. One who simply stops coming back releases it after about 12 hours.

Whoever raised you is recorded against your swearing and stays there. It cannot be traded, lost or undone.

A master takes 2 where anyone else takes one, and where there is nothing to double, their weapon comes back a quarter sooner.

RECIPES (CONTINUED)

 gold plate	11 gold bar
 gold chain	10 gold bar, 1 old chain
 bone staff	2 logs, 8 bones, 1 grave silver

RECIPES (CONTINUED)

	steel hatchet	1 steel, 1 oak logs
	steel pickaxe	1 steel, 1 oak logs
	steel sword	1 steel
	steel mell	2 steel, 1 oak logs
	steel helm	1 steel
	steel plate	2 steel
	steel dagger	1 steel
	steel spear	1 steel, 1 oak logs
	great hatchet	2 quick stone, 2 ironbark, 1 brimstone
	great pickaxe	2 quick stone, 1 ironbark, 1 brimstone
	gold bar	5 gold ore
	iron	2 iron ore
	steel	1 iron
	gold helm	6 gold bar

THE THINGS THERE IS ONLY ONE OF

Everything in the pages that follow is interchangeable: one log is any log. Three things are not. Each carries whose it was and the interval it was made on, and no two are the same object.

a wayfarer's hood Given for walking every trade. It has no defence and no price, and it survives the death that takes everything else.

a fall stone The last rock off a boulder somebody finished. The same rock as any rubble; the difference is who broke it and when.

an attuned chart An ordinary chart bound to one waystone.

None of them can be bought from a keeper, because a keeper deals in kinds and these have no kind. They change hands between people or not at all.

What one is worth is decided years after it is made, by whose name turns out to be on it. That cannot be known in advance and cannot be run ahead of.

CARRYING

Your pack holds 12 items. Crafting only uses what is in your pack, never what is in the bank, so you have to decide what to take before you leave town.

WORN

- Weapon
- Head
- Body
- Offhand
- Legs

RECIPES (CONTINUED)

 iron plate	3 iron
 iron shield	4 iron, 1 oak logs
 steel shield	3 steel, 1 ironbark
 quick shield	7 quick ingot, 1 ironbark
 gold legs	8 gold bar
 quick grit	5 quick stone
 quick ingot	8 quick grit
 quick alloy	1 quick ingot, 5 brimstone
 quick sword	6 quick ingot
 quick helm	5 quick ingot
 quick plate	10 quick ingot
 quick dagger	4 quick ingot
 quick hatchet	2 quick stone, 1 iron, 1 logs
 quick pickaxe	2 quick stone, 1 iron, 1 logs

RECIPES (CONTINUED)

	shot	1 iron, 1 gunpowder
	quick spear	6 quick ingot, 1 ironbark
	quick mell	9 quick ingot, 1 ironbark
	great helm	2 quick alloy
	great plate	5 quick alloy
	shell helm	2 crab shell, 1 iron
	shell plate	4 crab shell, 2 iron
	great sword	5 quick alloy, 1 ironbark
	great crossbow	4 quick alloy, 1 ironbark
	great mell	6 quick alloy, 1 ironbark
	iron sword	2 iron
	iron hatchet	1 iron, 1 logs
	iron pickaxe	1 iron, 1 logs
	iron helm	1 iron

KEEPING

Your pack holds 12 things and that is all you can carry. Everything else lives in a vault, and a vault belongs to the counter it stands at: what you put away in one town is in that town, not waiting for you in the next one.

You may hold up to **32** of them, one per counter. Crafting only ever reads your pack, never a vault, so what you take out before you leave is what you have.

HAULING

A store buys nothing and sells nothing. What it does is sign a consignment: goods entered at one counter, carried by you, and given up at another. The route may run to **8** stops.

It pays in wayfaring, not in coin, and it pays by the tile and by how much of the load you are carrying. A long road with a full pack is the whole of the wage.

The consignment is not your pack. It is a second container the bank cannot reach and you cannot eat out of.

ARMS

BOW marksmanship

 horn bow +	20	 hollow bow	1
 sigil bow +	30	 heartwood bow +	40

CROSSBOW marksmanship

 great crossbow +	70	 crossbow +	25
--	----	--	----

DAGGER prowess

 iron dagger	8	 steel dagger	35
 quick dagger	50		

JAVELIN marksmanship

 iron javelin	1	 steel javelin	15
 quick javelin	50		

MELL prowess

 iron mell +	22	 steel mell +	38
 quick mell +	55	 great mell	70

SPEAR prowess

 iron spear +	14	 steel spear +	35
--	----	---	----

RECIPES

 iron dagger	1 iron
 iron spear	1 iron, 1 logs
 iron javelin	1 iron, 1 logs
 steel javelin	1 steel, 1 logs
 quick javelin	1 quick ingot, 1 ironbark
 iron mell	2 iron, 1 logs
 sigil bow	1 horn bow, 3 sigil
 crossbow	2 iron, 2 logs
 quick flail	8 quick ingot, 1 ironbark
 fire siphon	4 steel, 6 brimstone, 1 ironbark
 bare blade	4 steel, 1 ironbark
 bone spear	2 dragon bones, 1 ironbark
 barb	2 lamprey spit, 1 steel
 handgonne	8 iron, 1 ironbark, 2 brimstone

THE KEEPERS (CONTINUED)

the brewer	brewer
the mourner	mourner
the innkeeper	innkeeper
the collier	collier
the drover	drover
the bridge keeper	toll
the beekeeper	beekeeper

Which town has which, and where they stand in it, this book does not say.

ARMS (CONTINUED)

 quick spear +	50	 bone spear +	50
---	----	--	----

SWORD prowess

 iron sword	15	 steel sword	35
 quick sword	50	 great sword +	70

OTHER

 barb	45	 bare blade	30
 bone staff	40	 fire siphon	60
 gold chain	30	 handgonne +	90
 quick flail +	55	 spade	260
 wand	6	 wooden bow +	8

Where a craft is named beside the family, the number is the level you need to hold the thing. Everywhere else it is what a stall ASKS for one, and blank means no stall sells it. Nothing in this world buys anything off you. A + means it takes both hands, so no shield.

ARMOUR

HELM

prowess

 iron helm	12	 steel helm	32
 quick helm	45	 great helm	70
 gold helm	45	 shell helm	15

PLATE

prowess

 iron plate	30	 steel plate	38
 quick plate	50	 great plate	70
 gold plate	50	 shell plate	15

OTHER

 king shroud	40
---	----

Where a craft is named beside the family, the number is the level you need to hold the thing. Everywhere else it is what a stall ASKS for one, and blank means no stall sells it. Nothing in this world buys anything off you. A + means it takes both hands, so no shield.

THE KEEPERS

Every town has some. Each one sells one thing only, and none of them buys anything: there is nobody in this world who will take an item off you for coin.

the axe man	lumber
the delver	delve
the arms master	arms
the armourer	armour
the fletcher	bows
the seedsman	seed
the banker	banker
the merchant	merchant
the sawyer	sawyer
the shepherd	shepherd
the delver	delver
the miller	millar
the quarrier	quarrier
the watchman	watchman
the wizard	wizard
the fisher	fisher

GATHERING (CONTINUED)

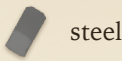
	deep fish spot	deep fish	78
	gibbet shoal	deep fish ×2	92
	tree	logs	1
	oak tree	oak logs	20
	ironbark tree	ironbark	45
	heartwood tree	heartwood	78
	gallows oak	heartwood ×2	92

This book does not say where any of it is on the island.

MADE THINGS

HATCHET				woodcraft	
	iron hatchet	10		steel hatchet	10
	quick hatchet	30		great hatchet	70
PICKAXE				earthcraft	
	iron pickaxe	10		steel pickaxe	10
	quick pickaxe	30		great pickaxe	70
SHIELD				prowess	
	iron shield	1		steel shield	30
	quick shield	48			
OTHER					
	gold bar	320		gold legs	45
	iron	5		quick alloy	
	quick grit			quick ingot	420
	shot	2			

MADE THINGS (CONTINUED)



steel

Where a craft is named beside the family, the number is the level you need to hold the thing. Everywhere else it is what a stall ASKS for one, and blank means no stall sells it. Nothing in this world buys anything off you. A + means it takes both hands, so no shield.

GATHERING

Everything you can gather from, what it gives, and the level you need to use it.

A small, dark grey, irregular rock icon.	rock	ore	1
A small, dark grey, irregular rock icon.	rockfall	rubble	1
A small, dark grey, irregular rock icon.	iron rock	iron ore	1
A small, dark grey, irregular rock icon.	coal rock	coal	20
A small, dark grey, irregular rock icon.	brimstone vent	brimstone	70
A small, purple, irregular rock icon.	quick rock	quick stone	78
A small, yellow, irregular rock icon.	gold rock	gold ore	85
A small, purple, irregular rock icon.	mother lode	quick stone ×2	92
A small, grey, irregular rock icon.	muck heap	saltpetre	25
A small, grey, irregular rock icon.	fishing spot	raw fish	1
A small, grey, irregular rock icon.	eel spot	eel	20

THE FOUR KINDS

flurry	several blows in one go, each rolled to hit as usual
whole	one blow at the weapon's hardest, and harder to land
now	does not wait for your arm after an ordinary swing
far	the damage comes from the range, not the weapon

A far shot is weaker than a dagger at touching range and the hardest blow in the world at the end of its nine tiles. The range is the whole of its damage, not an addition to it.

A report is the handgonne alone. Its burst was scaled down when a citizen's health became a flat sixty-four, and all of the damage went into the single shot: the hardest blow in the world, and the least accurate. It is the only gambit more likely to miss than to land.

What a gambit costs is not the same for every weapon. The recovery is measured against that weapon's own swing, so the cost column on the previous page is how many ordinary blows you gave up for it: four for a quick dagger, two for a mell, less than one for a handgonne.

Each kind is meant to pay that cost back in its own coin. A flurry pays in blows, a whole in size, a now in timing, a far in distance.

Master your own craft and the arm comes back a quarter sooner, which is what prowess gives instead of hitting harder.

GOODS

ARROWS

 fire arrows	12	 arrows	1
---	----	--	---

BONES

 dragon bones	500	 bones	2
--	-----	---	---

BREAD

 burnt bread	1	 bread	9
---	---	---	---

BROTH

 deep broth	24	 broth	10
--	----	---	----

DEEP FISH

 cooked deep fish	22	 salt deep fish	30
 burnt deep fish	1		

EEL

 cooked eel	13	 smoked eel	30
 burnt eel	1	 eel	7

FISH

 raw fish	3	 cooked fish	6
--	---	---	---

GOODS (CONTINUED)

 salt fish	11	 deep fish	11
---	----	---	----

LOGS

 oak logs	6	 logs	2
--	---	--	---

ORE

 iron ore	4	 gold ore	60
 ore	5		

ROD

shorecraft

 heartwood rod	70	 ironbark rod	30
 oak rod	10	 rod	10

STAFF

sorcery

 heartwood staff +	70	 staff +	6
--	----	--	---

OTHER

 ale	8	 brimstone	46
 charcoal	12	 chart	180
 charter	240	 coal	12

GAMBITS

Seven weapons have a move of their own. Blows is how many it lands. Recovery is how many intervals your arm is spent for afterwards. Costs is that recovery measured against the weapon's ordinary swing: how many normal blows you gave up to make this one.

		BLOWS	RECOVERY	COSTS
 dragonbow	far	1	4	2
 horn bow	flurry	3	6	3
 quick dagger	flurry	4	8	4
 fire siphon	now	1	4	2
 handgonne	report	1	3	0.75
 great mell	whole	2	3	1.5
 quick mell	whole	2	4	2

THE TIDE

The tide is the world's own clock, worked out from the interval count and nothing else. It is the same for everybody everywhere, nobody chose it, and nobody can move it.

There are 3 of them, turning at their own speeds. They gate nothing and cost nothing: what they are for is that anyone can say when the next one falls.

tide 1	up for 6 minutes, every 1 hours
tide 2	up for 15 minutes, every 5 hours
the deep tide	up for 30 minutes, every 12 hours

Only the deep tide is announced, and the announcement says where people actually stood at the last one. Nobody chose that place either: it stays the place only while people keep going there.

This is the closest thing the world has to an appointment. "At the deep tide" is something two strangers can agree on without either of them being able to move it.

GOODS (CONTINUED)

 crab shell	12	 flour	6
 grain	4	 grave silver	700
 gunpowder	60	 heartwood	15
 holy water	90	 ironbark	9
 lamprey spit	90	 planks	5
 quick stone	20	 saltpetre	14
sapling	40	 seeds	10
 wool	9		

Where a craft is named beside the family, the number is the level you need to hold the thing. Everywhere else it is what a stall ASKS for one, and blank means no stall sells it. Nothing in this world buys anything off you. A + means it takes both hands, so no shield.

THE SPELLS

There are 11 spells, split between two spellbooks. A citizen has one book or the other, never both. Casting a spell uses up a sigil.

THE COMMON BOOK

85	still	hold a fight still
	seal	hold a dropped pack for whoever lost it
1	transmute	turn a thing into money
50	mend	close your own wounds
50	mendp	close somebody else's, with a wand
	unmake	take a thing apart
	anchor	the recall to Anchor

None of these damage anyone. They block, heal or break things down.

THE WILDS

Most of the island is ordinary ground, where nobody may strike you without answering for it. The Wilds are not. Anybody may hunt anybody there, and nobody is coming.

Everything worth the most is there, which is the trade: the quick rock, the mother lode, the deep water, the gallows-oaks. You cannot reach the end of any craft without going, and every trip back is carrying something worth taking.

Magic will not carry you out of it either. The recall is the one spell that works there and it goes to Anchor, and you may be cut down in the middle of casting it.

THE LISTS

An isle off Fenmarch, reached by boat. Anybody may strike anybody, and no spell from either book works at all.

It is for a fight that is only about the fight. With the magic gone and nothing else in the way, a mell and a bare blade can be compared honestly.

WHAT IS COUNTED

Your deaths are counted, forever, and the number never falls. It is not a punishment and nothing in the world reads it except the boards. You are free to farm it if you want to, at the price of everything you are carrying each time.

Kills are **not** counted, and that is deliberate. A kill count would be worth something, and the cheapest way to earn it would be to make new citizens and cut them down. A death count is a joke you paid for.

WHAT CAN BE SAVED

At mourning 70 the most valuable priced thing you are carrying survives your death. Priced means a stall somewhere asks a price for it: the ore, the blades, the plate. What this world is really worth keeping is on no such list, and a sigil, a chart or an old chain is exactly as losable as it always was.

Somebody with a goo-staff can also seal your dropped pack where it lies, which holds it for you and stops it rotting. See the spells.

THE BARROW BOOK

The other spellbook. These are the ones that harm.

75 **waking**

40 **rot**

60 **taking**

88 **withering**

What each spell does, and what it costs, is not listed here.

No spell from either book works on the Lists.

WHAT A SPELL LEAVES ON YOU

A spell is cast in one interval and is over. What it leaves on the person it hit is not, and there are six of these. You will meet them before you ever cast anything.

stilled	You cannot strike. It wears off.
rooted	You cannot move from where you stand.
burning	You lose health every interval until it goes out.
rotting	The same, slower, and it came from the barrow book.
withered	Your blows land for less while it lasts.
branded	A mark on you that others can see.

Each of them ends by itself after a number of intervals. Nothing you carry removes one early, and dying does not clear them either.

You can see all six on somebody from across a square, which is the only warning this world gives you that a stranger has already cast.

DYING

When you are killed you drop everything you were carrying. It lies on the ground where you fell, for anyone to pick up, and it rots after a while like anything else left out.

The world pauses over you for 5 intervals and then you are up again. Nothing is taken from your crafts: levels do not fall here, and there is no penalty beyond the loss of what you had on you.